

Transparency rendering bug — demonstration (Fig. 5)

Page 1 below: the ORIGINAL figure as submitted. It contains ~2700 PDF transparency groups and a PDF/X output intent that forbids transparency. In viewers and submission/PDF A pipelines that drop or reject transparency, this page renders **blank** — this is what the reviewers saw.

Page 2: the SAME figure with transparency flattened (the fix). Zero transparency objects; renders identically everywhere.

To reproduce the failure, open this file in the journal's submission preview, convert it to PDF/A, or view it in a strict/browser PDF viewer: page 1 may appear blank while page 2 does not.



